DRAFT MINUTES – SUBJECT TO APPROVAL

Minutes of the General Government Committee Meeting Held Virtually at 1:00 p.m. on May 11, 2026

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
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Present:	Chair – Regional Councillor	-	S. Lee
	Regional Councillors	-	M. Crawford
		-	J. Dies
	Councillors	-	R. Tyler Morin
		-	N. Henry
		-	L. Bower
	Mayor	-	S. Collier (exited at 3:00 p.m.)

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair Lee called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

3.1. Regular Meeting

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on April 13, 2026 be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Couniclor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

3.2. Closed Meeting

Moved by: N. Henry

That the Minutes of the closed meeting of the General Government Committee held on April 13, 2026 be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

With the consent of Members present, Item 6 ‘Presentations’ was advanced in the order business.

6. Presentations

6.1. Financial Sustainability Plan Update

Julie Mepham, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer, introduced Christopher Balette, Associate Partner, Hemson Consulting Ltd. and Andrew Mirabella, Partner, Hemson Consulting Ltd.

A. Mirabella and C. Balette, delivered a presentation related to Financial Sustainability Plan Update.

Committee Members asked questions related to the presentation. A. Mirabella responded to questions from Committee Members.

There was no motion regarding this item.

6.2. FIN-2026-11: 2026 Financial Sustainability Plan Update

Kevin Douglas, Acting Supervisor of Accounting, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein.

Committee Members asked questions related to Item 6.1 ‘Financial Sustainability Update Plan’ and Item 6.2 ‘FIN-2026-11: 2026 Financial Sustainability Plan Update’. A. Mirabella and J. Mepham, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council receive for information the Financial Sustainability Plan final report as prepared by Hemson Consulting Ltd for the Town of Ajax.

2. That the following updated policies, included as ATT-4 to ATT-8, be approved:

    a) ATT-4: Policy #120 – Financial Sustainability Plan

    b) ATT-5: Policy #121 – Discretionary Reserve Administration

    c) ATT-6: Policy #122 – Discretionary Stabilization Reserves

    d) ATT-7: Policy #123 – Discretionary Capital Reserves

    e) ATT-8: Policy #124 – Debt Management

3. That the draft updated Procedure for Sale and Disposition of Land By-law, attached as ATT-9, be brought forward to the May 19, 2026 Council meeting for consideration.

4. That the Director of Finance be authorized to make administrative changes to other polices identified under #120 Financial Sustainability Plan to align with the goals stated in this report.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the motion be amended by adding the following:

2. That an investment reserve be created and any realized investment revenue in excess of 5% be allocated to this reserve on an annual basis up to a reserve balance of $5M. Once this target has been met, any further revenues be allocated to the Asset Management Reserve; and

3. That the allocation of assessment growth used to reduce the tax impact be capped at 0.75% annually and any amounts above this be allocated to the Asset Management Reserve; and

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4. That staff review the proposal to eliminate spending caps and consider decreasing the caps to 70% or $23.5M, whichever is less; and

5. That any non-allocated balance of the CIP reserve be transferred to the Strategic Initiatives Reserve; and

6. That staff report back to Council with the revised FSB and associated policies based on these changes, including:

    a. ATT-4: Policy #120 – Financial Sustainability Plan

    b. ATT-5: Policy #121 – Discretionary Reserve Administration

    c. ATT-6: Policy #122 – Discretionary Stabilization Reserves

    d. ATT-7: Policy #123 – Discretionary Capital Reserves

    e. ATT-8: Policy #124 – Debt Management; and

7. That the draft updated Procedure for Sale and Disposition of Land By-law, attached as ATT-9, be brought forward to the June 22, 2026 Council meeting for consideration.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council receive for information the Financial Sustainability Plan final report as prepared by Hemson Consulting Ltd for the Town of Ajax.

2. That an investment reserve be created and any realized investment revenue in excess of 5% be allocated to this reserve on an annual basis up to a reserve balance of $5M. Once this target has been met, any further revenues be allocated to the Asset Management Reserve; and

3. That the allocation of assessment growth used to reduce the tax impact be capped at 0.75% annually and any amounts above this be allocated to the Asset Management Reserve; and

4. That staff review the proposal to eliminate spending caps and consider decreasing the caps to 70% or $23.5M, whichever is less; and

5. That any non-allocated balance of the CIP reserve be transferred to the Strategic Initiatives Reserve; and

6. That staff report back to Council with the revised FSB and associated policies based on these changes, including:

    a. ATT-4: Policy #120 – Financial Sustainability Plan

    b. ATT-5: Policy #121 – Discretionary Reserve Administration

    c. ATT-6: Policy #122 – Discretionary Stabilization Reserves

    d. ATT-7: Policy #123 – Discretionary Capital Reserves

    e. ATT-8: Policy #124 – Debt Management; and

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7. That the draft updated Procedure for Sale and Disposition of Land By-law, attached as ATT-9, be brought forward to the June 22, 2026 Council meeting for consideration.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

6.3. OES-2026-10: ACC Recreation Master Plan Renovation - Concept Plan Approval ReportContract Award - Detailed Design for the ACC Recreation Master Plan Renovation

Jackson Christian, Supervisor of Facility Capital Projects & Asset Management, introduced Marcin Sztaba, Associate, Diamond Schmitt Architects.

Committee recessed at 2:47 p.m.

Committee resumed at 2:55 p.m.

M. Sztaba delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein.

Committee Members asked questions related to the presentation. M. Sztaba and Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Council endorse the Preferred Concept Plan for the Ajax Community Centre (ACC) Master Plan Renovation.

2. That Council award the Contract for the Detailed Design of the Ajax Community Centre Renovation and Expansion to Diamond Schmitt Architects in the amount of $2,861,160 (inclusive of all taxes).

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Regional Councillor Lee

CARRIED

6.4. PDS-2026-14: Stormwater Master Plan Update

Stephen Ruddy, Manager of Development Engineering, introduced Chris Denich, Director of Water Resources, Aquafor Beech Limited and Meaghan Dustin, Senior Water Resources Engineer, Aquafor Beech Limited.

M. Dustin delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein.

Committee Members asked questions related to the presentation. S. Ruddy responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That Council receive this report for information.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

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4. Consent Agenda

Committee Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6 and 4.7 for discussion.

4.1. PSA-2026-08: Lean Impact Report

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Christie McLardie, Director of Public & Strategic Affairs, Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, and Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

That Council receive this report for information.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.2. PSA-2026-09: Housing Accelerator Fund Update

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Affairs and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning Development Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: J. Dies

That this report be received for information.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.3. PSA-2026-10: Winter Warming - Town Hall Operational Summary

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. K. Brownridge responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: J. Dies

That Council receive this report for information.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.4. FIN-2026-10: 2025 Annual Investment Report

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. J. Mepham responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That the Annual Investment Report for the period January 1 to December 31, 2025, be received for information.

2. That the net cash reimbursement of $798,917.29 from the 2025 equity investment transaction in Elexicon be allocated to Strategic Initiatives Reserve.

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In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

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4.5. OES-2026-09: Contract Award - RFT No. T26036 - Accommodation Upgrade Project Phase III

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. D. Meredith and Regional Councillor Lee, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That Council award the Contract for Accommodation Upgrade Project Phase III, to Rodas McKnight Constructors Inc. in the amount of $222,124.10 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Staff award the contract for Contract Administration – Accommodation Upgrade Project Phase III' project, to Ward99 Architects Inc. in the amount of $6,169.80 (inclusive of all taxes).

3. That Council provide approval for a revision to the project scope to remove the Accommodation Upgrade for the modernization at Fire Station 1 (Headquarters) and redirect the remaining allocated capital budget of $349,902.14 to the modernization of the Building Maintenance and Fleet Services office spaces at the Operations Centre.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.6. OES-2026-08: Contract Award - T26038 MCC Parking Lot Reconstruction; Contract Administration & Inspection Services, Geotechnical Services

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That Council Award the Contract for MCC Parking Lot Reconstruction, to Peltar Paving and General Contracting Company Limited in the amount of $930,483.46 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council award the contract for Geotechnical Services – MCC Parking Lot Reconstruction to EnVision Consultants Ltd. in the amount of $35,118.14 (inclusive of all taxes).

3. That Council award the contract for Contract Administration & Inspection Services (Phase 2) – MCC Parking Lot Reconstruction to Gannett Fleming Canada ULC in the amount of $37,877.60 (inclusive of all taxes).

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.7. RCS-2026-02: St. Francis Centre Rebranding and 15th Anniversary Programming

Committee Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Due to technical issues, staff will report back to Committee Members.

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Moved by: N. Henry

1. That Council approve the renaming of the St. Francis Centre to “Ajax Centre for the Arts”.

2. That the St. Francis Centre 15th Anniversary Programming, taking place July 4-5, 2026, be received for information.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

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5. Discussion

None.

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Session and Related In-Camera Meeting

7.1. Elexicon Negotiations

Item 7.1 was withdrawn.

8. Adjournment (4:49 p.m.)

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the May 11, 2026 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Regional Councillor Lee

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